

Inventory Management System

Why are Data Structures and Algorithms Essential in Handling Large Inventories?

Data Structures and Algorithms play a vital role in inventory management systems, especially when dealing with large numbers of products.

1. Fast Access and Updates

A warehouse may contain thousands of products. Efficient data structures allow products to be searched, added, updated, and removed quickly, improving overall system performance.

2. Efficient Memory Usage

Choosing the appropriate data structure helps manage memory effectively, reducing unnecessary storage overhead and improving application efficiency.

3. Scalability

As the inventory grows, the system should continue to perform efficiently. Well-designed algorithms ensure that operations remain fast even with large datasets.

Suitable Data Structures for Inventory Management

ArrayList

- Suitable for small inventories.
- Maintains insertion order.
- Searching, updating, and deleting products by `productId` requires traversing the list.

Time Complexity

- Search: $O(n)$
- Update: $O(n)$
- Delete: $O(n)$

HashMap

- Ideal for large inventories.
- Uses `productId` as the key and `Product` as the value.
- Provides direct access to products.

Time Complexity

- Search: $O(1)$
- Update: $O(1)$

- Delete: $O(1)$
-

Time Complexity Analysis (Using ArrayList)

1. Add Product

```
public void addProduct(Product product){
    products.add(product);
    System.out.println("Product Added Successfully");
}
```

Time Complexity: $O(1)$

Adding an element to the end of an `ArrayList` is generally a constant-time operation.

2. Update Product

```
public void updateProduct(Product product) {
    for(Product prod : products){
        if(prod.getProductid() == product.getProductid()){
            prod.setProductName(product.getProductName());
            prod.setQuantity(product.getQuantity());
            prod.setPrice(product.getPrice());
            return;
        }
    }

    System.out.println("No Product Found");
}
```

Time Complexity: $O(n)$

The system must search through the list to find the matching `productId`. In the worst case, every product may need to be checked.

3. Delete Product

```
public void removeProduct(int productId){
    for(Product product : products){
        if(product.getProductid() == productId){
            products.remove(product);
            return;
        }
    }
}
```

```

        }
    }

    System.out.println("No Product Found");
}

```

Time Complexity: $O(n)$

The product must first be located using a linear search. After removal, the remaining elements may need to be shifted, resulting in $O(n)$ complexity.

Optimization Using HashMap

To improve performance, a `HashMap<Integer, Product>` can be used where:

- Key = `productId`
- Value = `Product` object

This allows direct access to products without traversing the entire collection.

1. Add Product

```

public void addProduct(Product product) {
    productsMap.put(product.getProductId(), product);
}

```

Time Complexity: $O(1)$

Insertion into a `HashMap` is constant time on average.

2. Update Product

```

public void updateProduct(int productId,
                          String productName,
                          int quantity,
                          double price) {

    Product product = productsMap.get(productId);

    if(product != null){
        product.setProductName(productName);
        product.setQuantity(quantity);
        product.setPrice(price);

        System.out.println("Product with ID " +

```

```

        productId +
        " Updated Successfully");
    }
    else{
        System.out.println("Invalid Product ID");
    }
}

```

Time Complexity: O(1)

Retrieving a product using its key from a `HashMap` is constant time on average.

3. Delete Product

```

public boolean deleteProduct(int productId) {

    if(productsMap.remove(productId) != null){
        System.out.println("Product with ID " +
            productId +
            " Removed Successfully");

        return true;
    }

    System.out.println("Invalid Product ID");
    return false;
}

```

Time Complexity: O(1)

Removing a product from a `HashMap` is constant time on average.

Conclusion

The current implementation using `ArrayList` is suitable for small inventories but becomes inefficient as the number of products increases because update and delete operations require $O(n)$ time.

For large-scale inventory systems, `HashMap` is the preferred data structure because it provides $O(1)$ average time complexity for add, update, search, and delete operations, resulting in better performance and scalability.